



Cadillac Utilities Department

July 14, 2026

Mr. Aaron Kline
Michigan Department of Environment, Great Lakes, and Energy (EGLE)
Cadillac District Office, Water Resources Division
120 West Chapin,
Cadillac, MI 49601-2158

Re: Violation Notice – VN No. VN-019184

Dear Mr. Kline,

This is in response to your letter dated June 10, 2026, in which you informed us of violations that occurred at the Cadillac wastewater treatment plant. We will describe what happened. I do believe this incident meets /exceeds the remedial design standard (RDS) storm event.

The incidents that led to this event are as follows:

- The Cadillac Area experienced an extreme ice storm in March 2026.
- The winter snow accumulation and ice accumulation melted at the end of March.
- Frost was still in the ground in April with no place for the snow/ice to infiltrate into the ground
- April had 11.79" of rain. 11.24" of rain fell in the first 18 days of the month. Please see attached rainfall report.
- Lake Cadillac and Lake Mitchell both overflowed their banks and water redistributed to low laying areas and flooded homes and sewers.
- The Cadillac Dam on the Clam River was completely open for March 2026 until Early July 2026. The Clam River is the only outlet for Lakes Cadillac, Lake Mitchell and the Mitchell swamp.
- The lake level high was 1292.5 Feet. This is 30" above the court ordered spring level of the lake.

I do believe when all the above information is taken into consideration it is easy to determine that the RDS was exceeded.

The water levels in the lake were higher than in the surrounding areas. Water, as you know, seeks the low areas. This caused major flooding of the city infrastructure and of residents' personal property.

This flooding allowed water to infiltrate into the sewer system through sewer lids and residential plumbing that was underwater for several days/weeks. This eventually caused the wastewater plant to partially bypass the tertiary treatment process of the plant.

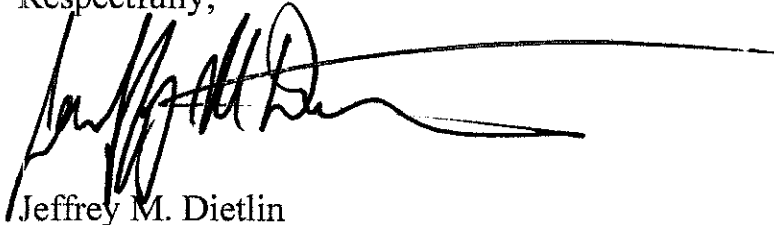
Cadillac does believe this is a once in a lifetime event and that it would be hard for the conditions that caused this event to ever happen again so close together.

Cadillac is confirming its understanding of the requirements to report untreated or partially treated sewage discharge. If in the future this event or a similar event occurs the reporting requirements will be followed.

It should be noted that correspondence with EGLE representatives seemed to indicate that because this is such an extraordinary event that we should get the report in "as soon as possible". No time frame was given.

At no time was it ever expressed that a violation letter **would not be issued** but this correspondence did lend itself to the interpretation that the notification wasn't required within 24 hours because of the unique situation. Please see the attached emails.

Respectfully,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read "Jeffrey M. Dietlin", with a long horizontal line extending to the right.

Jeffrey M. Dietlin
Director of Utilities
City of Cadillac
231-779-7346 direct line
231-775-0906 fax

Record of Climatological
Observations

These data are quality controlled and may not
be identical to the original observations.

Generated on 07/14/2026

Current Location: Elev: 1295 ft. Lat: 44.2655° N Lon: 85.3966° W
Station: CADILLAC, MI US USW00014817

Observation Time Temperature: Unknown Observation Time Precipitation: Unknown

Year	Month	Day	Temperature (F)		Precipitation				Evaporation		Soil Temperature (F)		
			"24 Hrs. Ending at Observation Time"		24 Hour Amounts Ending at Observation Time		At Obs. Time	Snow, Ice Pellets, Hail (in)	F i a g	Snow, Ice Pellets, Hail (in)	F i a g	4 in. Depth	
			Max.	Min.	At Obs.	Rain, Melted Snow, Etc. (in)						Ground Cover (see *)	Max.
2026	04	01	55	25	25	0.45							
2026	04	02	42	25	30	0.04							
2026	04	03	57	29	37	2.30							
2026	04	04	43	30	34	0.43							
2026	04	05	47	30	31	0.26							
2026	04	06	42	26	28	0.00							
2026	04	07	45	19	20	T							
2026	04	08	40	19	27	0.00							
2026	04	09	59	26	43	0.19							
2026	04	10	55	34	34	0.53							
2026	04	11	47	22	27	0.00							
2026	04	12	57	27	39	0.93							
2026	04	13	65	37	56	2.65							
2026	04	14	75	50	53	1.44							
2026	04	15	74	51	55	0.73							
2026	04	16	70	54	55	0.48							
2026	04	17	65	36	41	0.03							
2026	04	18	74	40	47	0.78							
2026	04	19	49	29	33	0.05							
2026	04	20	42	17	26	0.00							
2026	04	21	47	25	42	0.00							
2026	04	22	68	36	41	0.00							
2026	04	23	72	41	51	0.00							
2026	04	24	80	51	59	0.00							
2026	04	25	75	37	39	0.17							
2026	04	26	50	33	42	0.00							
2026	04	27	67	40	47	0.00							
2026	04	28	69	46	51	0.26							
2026	04	29	56	38	38	0.01							
2026	04	30	44	34	34	0.06							
Summary			58	34		11.79							

Empty, or blank, cells indicate that a data observation was not reported.

Ground Cover: 1=Grass; 2=Fallow; 3=Bare Ground; 4=Brome grass; 5=Sod; 6=Straw mulch; 7=Grass muck; 8=Bare muck; 0=Unknown

s* This data value failed one of NCEI's quality control tests. "At Obs." = Temperature at time of observation

T* values in the Precipitation or Snow category above indicate a "trace" value was recorded.

A* values in the Precipitation Flag or the Snow Flag column indicate a multiday total, accumulated since last measurement, is being used.

Data value inconsistency may be present due to rounding calculations during the conversion process from SI metric units to standard imperial units.

Jeff Dietlin

From: Kline, Aaron (EGLE) <KlineA4@michigan.gov>
Sent: Wednesday, April 22, 2026 10:27 AM
To: Patrick Miller; Jeff Dietlin
Subject: Division and Lesson Pump Station SSO Reporting

Greetings Jeff and Patrick,

Thank you for making me aware of the flooding issues the Division and Lesson Pump Station is experiencing while onsite yesterday. It is my understanding that the Army Corps of Engineers will be reaching out to assist in determining the structural integrity of the sand berm. I know you all are extremely busy on site of the pump station, but **it is very important to complete the proper SSO reporting as soon as possible**. This includes submitting an initial SSO report to EGLE, notifying the local health department, and notifying the local daily news.

Please let me know if you have any questions or if we can assist in any ways,

Thank you for your time,

Aaron Kline

Environmental Engineer
Water Resources Division
Cadillac District Office
Phone: (231) 429-9452



Jeff Dietlin

From: Kline, Aaron (EGLE) <KlineA4@michigan.gov>
Sent: Monday, April 27, 2026 11:07 AM
To: Patrick Miller; Jeff Dietlin
Subject: SSO Reporting

Greetings Patrick and Jeff,

I am reaching out for another reminder regarding the SSO reporting for the Division and Lesson Pump Station discharge that occurred Sunday, 4/19. An EGLE SSO report, a phone call to the local health department, and a phone call to the local daily news is required to be completed within 24 hours of the discharge occurring and these steps are essential for the protection of public health. My Cadillac WRD district supervisor and upper management is requesting daily flooding updates and would also like to review the SSO report. Please note, if this SSO report is not received by the end of this week, the WRD district supervisor will require a meeting to discuss proper discharge reporting steps.

We also discussed that max flows at the WWTP are unable to be treated in the tertiary treatment process and some of the flow is going from secondary treatment directly to disinfection. This is something EGLE considers a bypass of treatment and should also be reported as an "Other SSO – Discharge of partially treated sewage". All steps mentioned above should be followed for this report as well.

EGLE staff understand you all have your hands full with the historic flooding the city is experiencing, although these reports must be submitted as soon as possible. Please let me know if you have any questions or if we can help in any way.

Thank you for your time,

Aaron Kline

Environmental Engineer
Water Resources Division
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Phone: (231) 429-9452

